

Earth, Environment and Society
ENVSOCY 3HP3
Population, Health and Aging
Winter 2027



SCIENCE

Instructor Information

Lea Ravensbergen

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Office: GSB210

Office Hours:

TBD

Course Information

Weekly 2hr lecture + 1hr tutorial

Lectures: Thursdays, 14:30 – 16:20

Tutorials: Varied

Course Dates: 01/04/2027 - 04/07/2027

Units: 3.00

Course Delivery Mode: In Person

Course Description: Differential growth of human populations and their changing age and sex structures with an emphasis on birth, death, and immigration processes. The connections between population structures and processes and various aspects of environments and societies, including aging and health, are emphasized. One lecture (two hours), one tutorial (one hour); one term

Prerequisite(s): One of ENVSOCY 1HA3, 1HB3 **Cross-list(s):** HLTHAGE 3HP3

Hours of Study:

Instructor-Specific Course Information

Communication between Students & Instructional Team:

Important Links

- [Mosaic](#)
- [Avenue to Learn](#)
- [Student Accessibility Services - Accommodations](#)
- [McMaster University Library](#)
- [eReserves](#)
- [Open Education Resources](#)

Course Learning Outcomes

- Be familiar with population processes, their basic measures, and their challenges
- Understand the linkage between population, health, and the economy
- Engage critically with ideas in population geography
- Utilize appropriate skills to demonstrate knowledge of population issues

Required Materials and Texts

Please sign in with your MacID [here](#) to view your booklist

You are required to read one (short) reading weekly before your tutorial session. This reading will form the basis of the discussion. These readings are listed in the Class Schedule and are posted to Avenue to Learn.

The text for the lectures in this course is:

K. Bruce Newbold, Population Geography: Tools and Issues, 4th Edition.

The text is available at the McMaster Bookstore or online directly from the publisher, www.rowman.com . Used copies of the text are usually available as well.

You are expected to consult the text for additional insights and examples associated with the lecture material. The schedule of readings is included in the

Course Schedule section. To make the most of your experience, you should read this material prior to attending lecture.

Course Fees

INSTRUCTOR TO DETAIL COURSE SPECIFIC FEES HERE

Class Format

In Person

Course Evaluation

Type of Assignment	Weight	Due Date
Participation (8 in-class activities, 9 tutorials)	22%	Ongoing
Assignment 1	9%	October 11th @ start of class
Assignment 2	14%	November 29th @ start of class
Mid-term exam	20%	October 25th (In Class)
Final Exam (Cumulative)	35%	Exam Period
Total	100%	

Undergraduate Grading Scale

Grade	Equivalent Grade Point	Equivalent Percentages
A+	12	90-100
A	11	85-89
A-	10	80-84
B+	9	77-79
B	8	73-76
B-	7	70-72
C+	6	67-69
C	5	63-66
C-	4	60-62
D+	3	57-59
D	2	53-56
D-	1	50-52
F	0	0-49

Graduate Grading Scale

Graduate Student Grading Scale (Except for MBA and Master of Finance)

Grade	Points	Equivalent Percentage	Pass/Fail
A+	12	90-100	P+
A	11	85-89	P
A-	10	80-84	
B+	9	77-79	
B	8	73-76	
B-	7	70-72	
F	0	69 and under	F

MBA and Master of Finance Grading Scale

Grade	Points	Equivalent Percentage	Pass/Fail
A+	12	90-100	P+
A	11	85-89	P
A-	10	80-84	
B+	9	75-79	
B	8	70-74	
B-	7	60-69	
F	0	59 and under	F

Course Schedule

INSTRUCTOR TO DETAIL COURSE SPECIFIC SCHEDULE HERE

Laboratory Overview, Operation, and Safety

INSTRUCTOR TO ADD COURSE SPECIFIC INFORMATION HERE

Late Assignments

INSTRUCTOR TO ADD COURSE SPECIFIC INFORMATION HERE

Absences, Missed Work, Illness

INSTRUCTOR TO ADD COURSE SPECIFIC INFORMATION HERE

Turnitin.com

Some courses may use a web-based service (Turnitin.com) to reveal authenticity and ownership of student submitted work. For courses using such software, students will be expected to submit their work electronically either directly to Turnitin.com or via an online learning platform (e.g. A2L, etc.) using plagiarism detection (a service supported by Turnitin.com) so it can be checked for academic dishonesty.

Students who do not wish their work to be submitted through the plagiarism detection software must inform the Instructor before the assignment is due. No penalty will be assigned to a student who does not submit work to the plagiarism detection software. All submitted work is subject to normal verification that standards of academic integrity have been upheld (e.g., on-line search, other software, etc.). For more details about McMaster's use of Turnitin.com please go to www.mcmaster.ca/academicintegrity.

Generative AI: Use Prohibited

Students are not permitted to use generative AI in this course. In alignment with [McMaster academic integrity policy](#), it "shall be an offence knowingly to ... submit academic work for assessment that was purchased or acquired from another source". This includes work created by generative AI tools. Also state in the policy is the following, "Contract Cheating is the act of "outsourcing of student work to third parties" (Lancaster & Clarke, 2016, p. 639) with or without payment." Using Generative AI tools is a form of contract cheating. Charges of academic dishonesty will be brought forward to the Office of Academic Integrity.

Generative AI: Some Use Permitted

Example One

Students may use generative AI in this course in accordance with the guidelines outlined for each assessment, and so long as the use of generative AI is referenced and cited following citation instructions given in the syllabus. Use of generative AI outside assessment guidelines or without citation will constitute

academic dishonesty. It is the student's responsibility to be clear on the limitations for use for each assessment and to be clear on the expectations for citation and reference and to do so appropriately.

Example Two

Students may use generative AI for [editing/translating/outlining/brainstorming/revising/etc] their work throughout the course so long as the use of generative AI is referenced and cited following citation instructions given in the syllabus. Use of generative AI outside the stated use of [editing/translating/outlining/brainstorming/revising/etc] without citation will constitute academic dishonesty. It is the student's responsibility to be clear on the limitations for use and to be clear on the expectations for citation and reference and to do so appropriately.

Example Three

Students may freely use generative AI in this course so long as the use of generative AI is referenced and cited following citation instructions given in the syllabus. Use of generative AI outside assessment guidelines or without citation will constitute academic dishonesty. It is the student's responsibility to be clear on the expectations for citation and reference and to do so appropriately.

Generative AI: Unrestricted Use

Students may use generative AI throughout this course in whatever way enhances their learning; no special documentation or citation is required.

Course Specific Relief for Missed Academic Work Information

Requests for Relief for Missed Academic Term Work

In the event of an absence for medical or other reasons, students should review and follow the [Policy on Requests for Relief for Missed Academic Term Work](#).

INSTRUCTOR TO ADD COURSE SPECIFIC INFORMATION HERE

Checking Grades & Regrade Policy

Checking Your Grades

Your marks will be recorded on Avenue. It is your responsibility to check that all grades entered into Avenue are recorded properly. All grade concerns and discrepancies must be reported to the Instructional Assistant within a week of receiving the grade.

Regrade Policy

Office hours with the TAs (and or instructor/IA) will be arranged following assessments to address concerns students may have regarding their grade. Requests for re-evaluation of tests or assignments must be made in writing to the IA using the form provided in Avenue and justifying the reason for which the assignment should be remarked. This should be done within one week of discussing the marked test or assignment with the instructional team and BEFORE the final exam is written. If the IA considers the written justification to be insufficient (e.g. simply wanting a higher grade is insufficient), the assignment will not be re-graded. If the justification is considered sufficient, the entire assignment/test will be re-graded. Please be aware that this may result in an increase, decrease or no change to the original mark. There will be no alternative assignments that can be completed by students for the purpose of increasing their final grade.

APPROVED ADVISORY STATEMENTS

Academic Integrity

You are expected to exhibit honesty and use ethical behaviour in all aspects of the learning process. Academic credentials you earn are rooted in principles of honesty and academic integrity. **It is your responsibility to understand what constitutes academic dishonesty.**

Academic dishonesty is to knowingly act or fail to act in a way that results or could result in unearned academic credit or advantage. This behaviour can result in serious consequences, e.g. the grade of zero on an assignment, loss of credit with a notation on the transcript (notation reads: "Grade of F assigned for academic dishonesty"), and/or suspension or expulsion from the university. For information on the various types of academic dishonesty please refer to the [Academic Integrity Policy](#).

The following illustrates only three forms of academic dishonesty:

- plagiarism, e.g. the submission of work that is not one's own or for which other credit has been obtained.
- improper collaboration in group work.
- copying or using unauthorized aids in tests and examinations.

Authenticity / Plagiarism

Some courses may use a web-based service (Turnitin.com) to reveal authenticity and ownership of student submitted work. For courses using such software, students will be expected to submit their work electronically either directly to Turnitin.com or via an online learning platform (e.g. Avenue to Learn, etc.) using plagiarism detection (a service supported by Turnitin.com) so it can be checked for academic dishonesty.

Students who do not wish their work to be submitted through the plagiarism detection software must inform the Instructor before the assignment is due. No penalty will be assigned to a student who does not submit work to the plagiarism detection software. **All submitted work is subject to normal verification that standards of academic integrity have been upheld** (e.g., on-line search, other software, etc.). For more details about McMaster's use of Turnitin.com please go to www.mcmaster.ca/academicintegrity.

Courses with an On-line Element

Some courses may use on-line elements (e.g. e-mail, Avenue to Learn, LearnLink, web pages, capa, Moodle, ThinkingCap, etc.). Students should be aware that, when

they access the electronic components of a course using these elements, private information such as first and last names, user names for the McMaster e-mail accounts, and program affiliation may become apparent to all other students in the same course. The available information is dependent on the technology used. Continuation in a course that uses on-line elements will be deemed consent to this disclosure. If you have any questions or concerns about such disclosure please discuss this with the course instructor.

Online Proctoring

Some courses may use online proctoring software for tests and exams. This software may require students to turn on their video camera, present identification, monitor and record their computer activities, and/or lock/restrict their browser or other applications/software during tests or exams. This software may be required to be installed before the test/exam begins.

Conduct Expectations

As a McMaster student, you have the right to experience, and the responsibility to demonstrate, respectful and dignified interactions within all of our living, learning and working communities. These expectations are described in the [Code of Student Rights & Responsibilities](#) (the “Code”). All students share the responsibility of maintaining a positive environment for the academic and personal growth of all McMaster community members, **whether in person or online.**

It is essential that students be mindful of their interactions online, as the Code remains in effect in virtual learning environments. The Code applies to any interactions that adversely affect, disrupt, or interfere with reasonable participation in University activities. Student disruptions or behaviours that interfere with university functions on online platforms (e.g. use of Avenue 2 Learn, WebEx or Zoom for delivery), will be taken very seriously and will be investigated. Outcomes may include restriction or removal of the involved students’ access to these platforms.

Academic Accommodation of Students with Disabilities

Students with disabilities who require academic accommodation must contact [Student Accessibility Services](#) (SAS) at 905-525-9140 ext. 28652 or sas@mcmaster.ca to make arrangements with a Program Coordinator. For further information, consult McMaster University's [Academic Accommodation of Students with Disabilities](#) policy.

Requests for Relief for Missed Academic Term Work

In the event of an absence for medical or other reasons, students should review and follow the [Policy on Requests for Relief for Missed Academic Term Work](#).

Academic Accommodation for Religious, Indigenous, or Spiritual Observances (RISO)

Students requiring academic accommodation based on religious, Indigenous or spiritual observances should follow the procedures set out in the [RISO](#) policy. Students should submit their request to their Faculty Office ***normally within 10 working days*** of the beginning of term in which they anticipate a need for accommodation or to the Registrar's Office prior to their examinations. Students should also contact their instructors as soon as possible to make alternative arrangements for classes, assignments, and tests.

Copyright and Recording

Students are advised that lectures, demonstrations, performances, and any other course material provided by an instructor include copyright protected works. The Copyright Act and copyright law protect every original literary, dramatic, musical and artistic work, **including lectures** by University instructors.

The recording of lectures, tutorials, or other methods of instruction may occur during a course. Recording may be done by either the instructor for the purpose of authorized distribution, or by a student for the purpose of personal study. Students

should be aware that their voice and/or image may be recorded by others during the class. Please speak with the instructor if this is a concern for you.

Extreme Circumstances

The University reserves the right to change the dates and deadlines for any or all courses in extreme circumstances (e.g., severe weather, labour disruptions, etc.). Changes will be communicated through regular McMaster communication channels, such as McMaster Daily News, Avenue to Learn and/or McMaster email.